

KF Mini-Meeting Lesson 17

--"MINI-MEETING" FORMAT-- (20 min)

I - MINDFULLNESS (4 min)

-ANB (1 min)

-3 Minute Breathing Space (3 min)

II - CHECK-IN (10 min)

-KF Member "A" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

-KF Member "B" shares (5 min)

(1) What I learned

(2) Signs of MO

(3) Signs of Orientation

(4) Five things I am thankful for

III - KF MEETING "PREVIEW" (6 min)

-Bible Teaching -- selected excerpt of previous week KF Bible teaching (5 min)

-Ending Prayer (1 min)

BIBLE TEACHING

Our text for this lesson is found in the letter from James, chapter 4. Nancy's paraphrase of this passage incorporates our KF understanding of the Idol and the True Self.

Prayer is courageously and consistently asking, seeking, and knocking. Here is another way to think about prayer: When we ask God for something, we are also inviting God to reveal the pride that we have invested in the situation. Honest prayer gives God permission to reveal our pride so that He can safely provide for us. If He does not deal with our pride before He provides for us, He will risk our personal development and the potential of our relationship with Him. God promises to guide us while we humbly knock on doors that may lead to our solutions. Tackling our problems can feel like death, especially when our pride is threatened. It is so painful! But only by going through the valley of the shadow of death with God do we learn to trust Him and discover by experience how trustworthy He is.

Helen Keller, a woman with great limitations who lost both her sight and her hearing as a baby, said this: *The best way out is always through. (Repeat)* She may have been quoting the American poet Robert Frost, who said: *The only way out is through.* The only way out of your problem is to go through it. The only way to the banquet is through the valley of the shadow of death. It is in the valley that you are trained and cleansed for your provision and your mission. Without your pride, the valley will be much more manageable and productive. You can learn to actually rejoice in your training.

Let's read Nancy's paraphrase of **James 4:1–6**. The **Expanded Version** of this teaching includes verses 7–10.

¹What is the cause of warfare and fighting among you and within you? Don't these causes come out of your malicious desires that advance like an army against your True Self and God, stirring up conflict within your own physical body and with other people?

²You set your heart upon some outcome and then it doesn't happen. So, you feel murderous and envious because you do not have the power to get your own way. You fight others and are at war within yourself, but you cannot have what you want, because you do not speak your reality moderately and ask for what you want. ³When

you do ask for what you want, you cannot attain it because you ask for things that support the Idol Self in order to expend your real gifts on your malicious desires.

⁴Adulterers, do you not see that cozying up with the Idol's system of values and strategies makes you an enemy of God? Therefore, whoever is willing to be on the side of the Idol takes the position of enmity toward God. ⁵Do you suppose that the Scripture does not mean it when it says that the spirit that dwells in us wastes away through cravings? ⁶ Scripture offers us a great gift when it shows us that God marshals Himself like an army against those who believe that they and their desires are superior to His purposes. Scripture also encourages us that God offers gifts of relationship to those who actively choose to take a low place, ready to please Him and to learn.

Take a deep breath.

In its unrelenting search for an imagined glory, our Idol Self makes unreasonable demands, like the demand for perfection. Our covetous desires support the claim that we are special and entitled and, therefore, deserve to have everything go perfectly. We claim to always be right because being right strokes our pride. We believe that we should always be able to do, or not do, whatever we want, without any adverse consequences. No wonder there is so much strife and discontent! We are all imposing our craving desires on others and fighting to have things go our way! We obsess about what we don't have. We obsess about forcing our "right" judgments on life, based on the rabid froth of our compulsive needs and pride system. And when our pride is threatened, our self-hate is so terrifying that we have to lie to ourselves in order to survive; we must make ourselves believe that we are other than we are—and we must force others to support that belief. We imagine that if we can make the world and others be what we want them to be, we will be able to rest for a moment. Tolstoy, the acclaimed Russian novelist, put it this way: *In our world everybody thinks of changing humanity, and nobody thinks of changing himself. (Repeat)*

The antidote to claims is this: choose to stop setting yourself up as the righteous judge of all the earth, full of extraordinary knowledge and vision. God is ready to offer you the gifts of karis relationship if you choose to take the low place, seeking to please Him and learning how to do things His way. The **Claim and Blame Worksheet** helps you to recognize your misorientation and view from a more empowering perspective what is going on around you. It helps you see how your pride is creating more pain. Joy does not come from having your compulsive needs met by others or by God. Joy is the Fruit of the Spirit, produced by a True Self that is deeply connected to God.

Our prayer might go something like this:

Be the source of true pleasure in my soul, O God. (Repeat)

Take a deep breath.

ENDING PRAYER

Dear Father and Creator, T

Thank You for this time together of healing and training. Hold us in the power of this new direction as You guide us to our real glory and to truth. Reveal the evidence of who we are as You lead us to the next step in our healing this week. Encourage us to co-labor with You to reorient our own lives for a more effective flow and to flourish in our connection with our True Self and design, with our community and the rest of Creation, and with You, for the glory and honor of our Lord Jesus. Amen.

Take a deep breath.